

Communications Plan: City of London Sports & Rec

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Introduction

The City of London is launching our Swim for Safety campaign to promote our swimming lessons programs. Our Swim for Safety program will be an awareness campaign to reduce drowning fatalities by educating children and parents on the dangers of unsupervised swimming and being in the water with inadequate swimming abilities.

For this campaign, we will release new advertising content and use our social media accounts to engage our viewers about the risks and attract new parents to the program. Displaying the risks and engaging with followers will also create more retention of current clients enrolled in the swimming programs.

Background

The leading activity connected to drowning in Ontario is swimming. The Lifesaving Society reported that 39 per cent of drowning fatalities took place during recreational swimming; 34 per cent was from a lack of swimming capabilities while 31 per cent was the result of swimming alone.¹ The City of London provides services for ages under three, three to five years and for ages five and up.

With the swimming education services offered by the City of London, Pan-American Health organization reports that children between the ages of one and four, followed by the ages five to nine, are at the highest risk for drowning. Males also have double the mortality rate in drowning cases compared to females.²

¹ Lifesaving Society, "Lifesaving Society," Lifesaving Society, 2020, https://www.lifesavingsociety.com/media/327287/lifesaving_drowning-2020_on_en_2020-06-13.pdf.

² Pan-American Health Organization. "Drowning Prevention." PAHO/WHO | Pan American Health Organization, 2023. <https://www.paho.org/en/topics/drowning-prevention>.

Goal

Enroll more children in swimming lessons as a means to prevent drowning and encourage water awareness

SMART Objectives

Goal 1: Enroll more children in swimming lessons as a means to prevent drowning and encourage water awareness

Objective 1: Increase water safety awareness

To have an effect on the awareness of parents with children in London; specifically to increase the level of understanding about water safety: 30 per cent of families within four months.

Objective 2: Change or amplify positive beliefs about swimming lessons

To have an effect on the acceptance of parents with children in London; specifically to increase their belief toward the importance of swimming lessons: 20 per cent of families within four months.

Objective 3: Increase swimming lesson enrollment

To have an effect on the action of parents with children in London; specifically to gain growth in program enrolment: 20 per cent within four months and an additional 10 per cent increase in program customer retention within four months.

Objective 4: Decrease drowning incidents

To have an effect on the action of children in London; Specifically to reduce the number of drowning incidents in London: 10 per cent within one year.

Key Performance Indicators

Objective 1: Increase water safety awareness

KPI 1: Survey results with above 50 per cent of respondents reporting they've learned something new about water safety

KPI 2: Increased individual attendance at water safety workshops, classes, and training sessions

KPI 3: Grow engagement with online water-safety resources: websites and social media

Objective 2: Change or amplify positive beliefs about swimming lessons

KPI 1: Survey results with above 50 per cent of respondents reporting changed or amplified beliefs

KPI 2: More Aware Publics become Active Publics

KPI 3: Secure media coverage and press mentions related to campaign

Objective 3: Increase swimming lesson enrollment

KPI 1: Increased registrations

KPI 2: Increased link clicks on lesson registration from social media, ads and websites

KPI 3: Calculate percentage increase of individual enrollment compared to baseline

Objective 4: Decrease drowning incidents

KPI 1: Less reported drowning incidents

KPI 2: Less reported water-related emergencies

KPI 3: Increase of individual life-guard certifications from swimming lesson program

Research Summary & Research Tools

Primary Research

Surveys

- Using email lists and Facebook polls to understand what our audience thinks and knows about water safety and City of London swimming lessons

Social media monitoring

- Analyzing social media metrics to find out what audiences are paying attention to our content as well as when they consume our content and how many

Web traffic analysis

- Using web traffic tracking tools like Google Analytics, Google Search Console and Hotjar to understand who is coming to our website, where are they navigating to and how many people are clicking on our site

Email lists

- Using email lists to share and collect information from parents and partnering organizations

Attendance analysis

- Analyzing who is coming and how many people are coming to swimming lessons

Secondary Research

Scholarly articles

- JSTOR and Google Scholar

News outlets

- CBC, CTV, Global, London Free Press

Active Publics

- Elgin County Drowning Prevention Coalition and Lifesaving Society

Situational Analysis

SWOT Analysis

Strengths

Social Media

- City of London Instagram: 26,400 followers
- City of London Twitter: 71,100 followers
- London Aquatics Facebook 5,400 followers
- London Aquatics Instagram has a strong reach with reels: lowest is 289 views and highest is 2,151 views

19 pool facilities

- Hold an increase in class sizes.

Weaknesses

Social media

- London aquatics Instagram: 1,000 followers
- London aquatics Facebook has minimal interactions on posts: one post has over 100 interactions in the last year

Recovering from lifeguard shortage

- In 2022, London had to cut multiple swimming lesson courses from employment shortage

Opportunities

Engaging with more Active Publics

- Finding new organizations with water safety resources can help our department find new ways to increase lesson enrollment and decrease drowning incidents

School swim team partnerships (Mr. Beast)

- Partnering with high school swimming teams, as well as the Western Mustangs, can influence more children to join swim lessons because of influencer marketing and athlete likeness, especially at the university level

Threats

Slashed budgets

- Slashed budgets lead to downsizing, high staff turnover, and salary or wage cuts

Non-drowning related pool injuries

- Falling on the pool floor or running into unmarked, hard pool items could cause unintentional injuries

Lawsuits

- Families affected by water contamination and injuries could file lawsuits that could lead to slashed budgets

Negative media coverage

- Lawsuits or significant amounts of water contamination and injuries that reach the media could lead to a problematic image and reputation

Loss of Active Publics

- If our reputation takes a hit due to negative media coverage, lawsuits, injuries and water contamination could lead to organizations leaving our partnership

Risks Summary

Risk 1: Slashed budgets

The Sports and Recreation department, like any other municipal government department, is prone to budget cuts. A smaller budget could lead to other risks like downsizing, high staff turnover, and salary or wage cuts.

Mitigation Strategy 1: Maintain a strong social media presence to keep lesson enrollment high through spring 2024

Mitigation Strategy 2: Develop and maintain strong relationships with organizations that advocate for water-safety and drowning-prevention programs

Risk 2: Negative media coverage

Negative media coverage of the campaign might result in lower public trust, lower attendance and less registrations for swimming lessons.

Mitigation Strategy 1: Develop crisis action plan in advance to enhance reaction time to negative coverage and maintain transparency with the public.

Mitigation Strategy 2: Maintain and strengthen relationships within media organizations

Risk 3: Loss of Active Public

Loss of active publics and the support of community stakeholders could limit the effectiveness of the drowning-prevention events related to the campaign.

Mitigation Strategy 1: Develop strong relationships with partner organizations through collaborative events such as fundraising. social media outreach

Mitigation Strategy 2: Create social media strategy with partner organizations in order to produce collaborative media to drive engagement

Audience Analysis

Publics			
Customers	Parents with children enrolled in swimming programs.	Parents who have eligible children for the program that have not yet enrolled.	Parents who have children that were enrolled and no longer take use the program.
Limiters	Other swimming programs. Ex; YMCA, Boys and Girls Club, The Aqua Life.	London's Child and Youth Network. (Program pricing may not be accessible to all families).	People with children under 12, needing supervision to attend the city's pools.
Enablers	Social Media	Current customers and past customers.	Organizations and people that align with our goals. Ex; Swim instructors and Lifesaving Society
Producers	City Council	<u>Indoor Pools</u> Canada Games Aquatic Centre	Swim instructors who are employed by the program.

		Carling Heights Optimist Community Centre East Lions Community Centre South London Community Pool <u>Outdoor Pools</u> Byron Pool Gibbons Pool Glen Cairn Pool Northeast Pool Northridge Pool Oakridge Pool Southcrest Pool Silverwood Pool Stonach Pool Westminister Pool	
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Non-publics	People who have mobile disabilities and are unable to swim.	Those who already are adequate swimmers.	
Latent public	New parents who are now involved in their children's safety.	Constant care providers.	Canada's newcomers who may not have aquatic experience.
Active public	Lifesaving Society	London Public Health	Elgin County Drowning Prevention Coalition
Aware public	Early childhood educators and teachers. (Work with the age group that has the highest drowning rate).	Citizens who have experienced trauma from water safety.	London Power and Sail Squadron

Key Messages

Objective 1: Increase water safety awareness

Enablers:

- “Your support can save lives: join us in our mission to prevent drownings and promote water safety.”
- Water safety is a fundamental life skill, your involvement with events and with spreading awareness helps amplify our message. Preventing further tragedies and ensuring our message is relayed to a broad and diverse audience.
- Your commitment and belief through continued financial support can directly fund swimming lesson programs and water safety initiatives in underserved communities.

Objective 2: Change or amplify positive beliefs about swimming lessons

Aware:

- “Ignorance can be deadly. Most drownings are preventable with a bit of knowledge. Learn to become a lifesaver today!”
- Over ninety per cent of drownings are preventable. Awareness can break down misconceptions and can ensure parents and children can make better choices when enjoying a splash in the pool or a quick swim.
- Be loud! Share water safety tips, drowning prevention messages, and info about swimming lessons with friends, family and community. Your voice and commitment can be a powerful for change.

Objective 3: Increase swimming lesson enrollment

Customers:

- “Dive into confidence, swim towards safety. Learn about water safety today.”
- Valued members of the community, swimming is a beloved past time for many in the Forest City and with fun always come safety. Join us in our campaign to reduce drownings and increase swimming lesson registration, empowering you and your loved ones to swim with absolute confidence.
- When you register for swimming lessons, you’re joining a community of people who care about safety and well-being. Your participation and awareness help foster a culture where everyone looks out for each other in and around the water.

Objective 4: Decrease drowning incidents

Active:

- “Turn a passion into a lifesaving skill: Stay fit, swim safe, Have fun!”
- Channel your passions for an active lifestyle and learn a valuable skill. Join us in our mission to reduce drownings and increase swimming lesson registration. Let’s make every swim a safe and thrilling adventure.
- Incorporate a safety-conscious mindset into your active lifestyle. Most drownings are preventable, knowing how to swim and how to be safe around the water can not only reduce risk but also opens up new possibilities for adventure.

Strategies and Tactics

Goal: Enroll more children in swimming lessons as a means to prevent drowning and encourage water awareness

Objective 1: Increase water safety awareness

Strategy 1: Conduct surveys with parents of young children in the program.

Tactic 1: Conduct email surveys through registration email list.

Tactic 2: Conduct Facebook polls survey

Strategy 2: Increase the use of online resources and workshops.

Tactic 1: Connect with members of the Western University swim team to take part in advertising.

Tactic 2: Use Google Search Console to optimize SEO

Objective 2: Change or amplify positive beliefs about swimming lessons

Strategy 1: People in the aware public become part of the active public.

Tactic 1: Partner with Lifesaving society to expand national drowning prevention week by assigning directors to meet with schools and integrate a swim safety week for London schools to have educators involved in swim safety.

Tactic 2: Connect with London Power and Sail Squadron for a joint event about boat and recreational swim safety aligning both of our interests.

Objective 3: Increase swimming lesson enrollment

Strategy 1: Marketing and advertising campaign

Tactic 1: Social media posts, promote and disseminate interactive media, follow trends on Tiktok - replicate.

Tactic 2: Physical products for elementary schools and partner organizations such as posters and interactive quizzes.

Strategy 2: Create landing pages for links to all social media and to the registration site.

Tactic 1: Link in bio posts on Facebook and Instagram

Tactic 2: Use of email list to directly send links to customers

Objective 4: Decrease drowning incidents

Strategy 1: Secure positive media coverage on swimming lesson program

Tactic 1: Collaborate on media piece, showcasing program and relaying advantages

Tactic 2: Complete program and fulfill campaign schedule - showcase metrics on social media

Action Plan

Tactic	Audience	Delivery Date	Responsibility
Email survey through email list	Current & past customers	Sept. 6, 2024	Social Media Coordinator
Conduct Facebook poll	Current & past customers	Sept 1, 2024	Social Media Coordinator
Connect with members of Western University swim team for advertising events.	Potential customers & advocacy partnerships	March 18, 2024	Public Relations Staff

Use Google Search Console for SEO	Current customers, potential customers, advocacy organizations, lifeguards, public health organizations & educators.	Updating and collecting analytics weekly starting Jan. 4, 2024	Marketing Specialist
Partner with Lifesaving Society	Lifesaving Society	Jan. 9, 2024	Public Relations Staff
Connect with London Power and Sail Squadron	London Power and Sail Squadron	July 15 to 19, 2024 (National Drowning Prevention Week)	Public Relations Staff
Promote and disseminate interactive media, and follow TikTok trends	Current & past customers	Jan. 4, 2024	Social Media Coordinator
Physical products for elementary schools and partner organizations	Teachers, school administration, partner organizations	Jan. 9, 2024	Public Relations Staff and Lifesaving Society
Link in bio posts on social media	Current & past customers	March 8, 2024 (Summer program registration opens.)	Social Media Coordinator
Send links via email list	Current & past customers	Ongoing updates starting Jan. 4, 2024 (Bi-weekly)	Social media coordinator
Collaborate on media piece	Public	Aug. 20, 2024	Communications Coordinator
Complete program and fulfill campaign schedule	Current customers	Nov. 4, 2024	Communications Coordinator

Evaluation

Planning

- Surveys will be shared via email on Sept. 6, 2024
- Social media and web traffic metrics will be continuously monitored with weekly and monthly results
- Prepare and finalize email lists
- Organize preliminary attendance record templates

Implementation

- Identify what primary research is showing positive, negative and stagnant results
- Report weekly and monthly results for social media and web traffic metrics

Post-campaign

- Analyze final metrics from survey results, social media, web traffic, email lists and attendance records
- Analyze annual drowning statistics
- Report final statistics to City of London

Appendix

Brenner, Ruth A, Gitanjali S Taneji, Denise L Haynie, Ann C Trumble, Cong Qian, Ron M Klinger, and Mark A Klebanoff. *Association Between Swimming Lessons and Drowning in Childhood*, September 2, 2014, 203–203.
<https://doi.org/10.1001/archpediatrics.2008.563>.

Lifesaving Society. "Lifesaving Society." Lifesaving Society, 2020.
https://www.lifesavingsociety.com/media/327287/lifesaving_drowning-2020_on_en_2020-06-13.pdf.